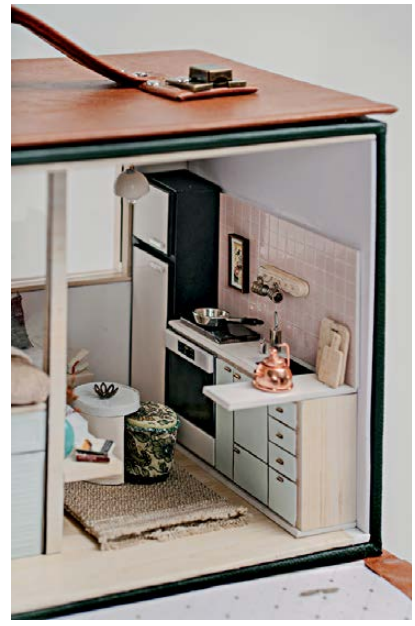




MAKING ROOM
Various angles of the travelling home show how much detailing has gone into creating it



Do you wish you could pack your entire home (literally) into a suitcase and take it on your travels? Miniaturist, book artist and writer Ruchika Nambiar has turned that into a reality for Little R (Nambiar's miniature alter ego), under The Dollhouse Project (an interactive comedy-drama set in a miniature parallel universe).

Little R's second residence, befittingly called The Travelling Home was created so that she could accompany Nambiar on her travels around the world. She has used her bookbinding skills to hand-craft the suitcase. "It was constructed with foamcore and fibreboard, and then wrapped in tan and dark green rexine fabric. The suitcase label was laser-etched onto a metallic copper plate. The buckles, clasps, nuts and bolts were sourced online from Amazon," says Nambiar.

It was back in 2023 that Nambiar felt Little R needed a second home. "The miniature apartment itself was constructed over a few weeks—the furniture was laser cut out of MDF, the wooden surfaces and tiled backsplash were printed on various types of paper. The bedding and upholstery was made of different lightweight fabrics," says Nambiar, adding, "Jewellery making supplies were used to create hardware like sink faucets, cabinet handles, towel rings and more. Books and artwork were scaled down digitally and then printed in miniature."

Having travelled through multiple airports, in its first two weeks, it went to Amsterdam, New York and Providence (Rhode Island). "Most recently, it accompanied me to a talk I gave at the Rhode Island Handicraft Club," says Nambiar. This year, she is on the lookout for more such opportunities to travel with the suitcase home.

So, is it possible for you to get your own version? The good news is that since Nambiar works on highly customised miniature commissions sky's the limit, with the cost varying from project to project. What's next? In 2024, Little R will be launching her own freelance advice and counselling services: 'No Problem Too Small'.

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AT www.ruchikanambiar.com